

Juan David Gelvez

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PhD candidate in Government at the University of Maryland with expertise in data analytics, causal inference, and policy evaluation. Experienced in leading multi-country research projects, building large datasets, and advising governments and international organizations on security and governance policy. Interested in applying advanced analytics and problem-solving skills to strategy and public sector consulting.

Education **University of Maryland, USA**

Ph.D., Government and Politics, (2026 expected).

Comparative Politics & Computational Methods.

M.A., Government and Politics, 2023.

Universidad de Los Andes, Colombia

M.A., Public Policy (MPP), 2018.

B.S., Government and Public Affairs, 2016.

Professional Experience

University of Maryland

Graduate Researcher, Interdisciplinary Laboratory of Computational Social Science, 2021–Present

- Built statistical and machine learning models using large observational datasets.
- Designed and analyzed four nationally representative surveys on governance and public trust.
- Produced 10 peer-reviewed publications applying advanced quantitative methods to policy evaluation.
- Received more than 10 awards, fellowships, and visiting positions.

Inter-American Development Bank

Academic Consultant, Citizen Security Division, 2025

- Produced a policy paper with actionable recommendations on crime, governance, and climate risks.

Georgetown University

Research Fellow, Department of Government, 2024- 2025

- Led a team of 15 researchers across multiple countries to map legal and accountability institutions in the Americas.
- Built cross-national datasets and co-authored policy reports informing governance and institutional reform debates.

Departamento Nacional de Planeación, Colombia

Team Coordinator and Policy Analyst, Security and Defense Area, 2019 - 2021

- Managed a team of 5 analysts designing and evaluating national security and justice policies.
- Coordinated a national public policy design and its evaluation strategy.
- Built a nationwide dataset covering 1,000+ municipalities to assess security policy implementation.
- Advised senior government officials and coordinated partnerships with national and international institutions.

Fundación Ideas para la Paz, Colombia

Researcher, Crime Dynamics Team, 2018-2019

- Analyzed administrative data on crime and drug policies in Latin America.
- Wrote more than 7 policy papers on drug policy and development.
- Advised national and local governments to translate evidence into guidance for programs and public safety strategies.

Universidad de Los Andes, Colombia

Research and Teaching Assistant, School of Government, 2016-2018

- Supported research on conflict, security, and political behavior.
- Assisted three courses on security policy, quantitative analysis, and international affairs.

Selected Publications

- 2025. Predicting Police and Military Violence: Evidence from Colombia and Mexico Using Machine Learning Models. *Humanities and Social Sciences Communications - Nature*.
- 2025. Rewards, Sanctions, and Trust in the Police: Evidence from Colombia. *Policing & Society*. With Cesar Mantilla and María Nieto.

Skills

- Languages: Spanish (native), English (advanced), Portuguese (intermediate).
- Programming and Data: R, SQL, Stata, Python, ArcGIS.
- Methods: causal inference, machine learning, survey design, policy evaluation.
- Tools: LaTeX, Markdown.

Extracurricular: Triathlete, certified scuba diver, and specialty coffee barista.

Last updated on March 24, 2026